

Seminar Assessment Report

Title:	Mathematics				
Professor(s):	Prof. A. Villanacci				
Teaching Assistant(s):	Elia Morracci				
Year:	2020 - 2021	Term:	BLOCK 1	Department:	ECO
Participants:	22	Forms returned:	21	Return:	95.45%

	Answers	%
Q1. In overall terms I am satisfied with the professor?		
5 - Very much	19	90.48%
4 - Considerably	2	9.52%
3 - Average	0	0.00%
2 - Not Very much	0	0.00%
1 - Not at all	0	0.00%
NA / No Answer	0	0.00%
Q2. The professor was well organised and well prepared?		
5 - Very much	19	90.48%
4 - Considerably	2	9.52%
3 - Average	0	0.00%
2 - Not Very much	0	0.00%
1 - Not at all	0	0.00%
NA / No Answer	0	0.00%
Q3. The professor was clear in his/her presentations and explanations?		
5 - Very much	18	85.71%
4 - Considerably	3	14.29%
3 - Average	0	0.00%
2 - Not Very much	0	0.00%
1 - Not at all	0	0.00%
NA / No Answer	0	0.00%

Q4. The professor teaches with interest and enthusiasm?

5 - Very much	20	95.24%
4 - Considerably	1	4.76%
3 - Average	0	0.00%
2 - Not Very much	0	0.00%
1 - Not at all	0	0.00%
NA / No Answer	0	0.00%

Q5. Where appropriate, the professor encourages class participation?

5 - Very much	15	71.43%
4 - Considerably	6	28.57%
3 - Average	0	0.00%
2 - Not Very much	0	0.00%
1 - Not at all	0	0.00%
NA / No Answer	0	0.00%

Q6. The professor was available and approachable outside seminar hours?

5 - Very much	13	61.90%
4 - Considerably	3	14.29%
3 - Average	1	4.76%
2 - Not Very much	0	0.00%
1 - Not at all	0	0.00%
NA / No Answer	4	19.05%

Q7. The professor developed the overall themes of the course/seminar in a coherent manner?

5 - Very much	18	85.71%
4 - Considerably	3	14.29%
3 - Average	0	0.00%
2 - Not Very much	0	0.00%
1 - Not at all	0	0.00%
NA / No Answer	0	0.00%

Q8. Recommended lectures, articles and books have been useful and sufficient?

5 - Very much	16	76.19%
4 - Considerably	3	14.29%
3 - Average	0	0.00%
2 - Not Very much	0	0.00%
1 - Not at all	0	0.00%
NA / No Answer	2	9.52%

Q9. After taking this course/seminar my interest in the given subject has increased?

5 - Very much	12	57.14%
4 - Considerably	6	28.57%
3 - Average	3	14.29%
2 - Not Very much	0	0.00%
1 - Not at all	0	0.00%
NA / No Answer	0	0.00%

Q10. Indicate how often you attended the course/seminar

5 = (9 to 10 sessions)	20	95.24%
4 = (7 to 8 sessions)	0	0.00%
3 = (5 to 6 sessions)	0	0.00%
2 = (3 to 4 sessions)	0	0.00%
1 = (less than 3 sessions)	0	0.00%
NA / No Answer	1	4.76%

Q11. What was the main reason you chose the course/seminar?

5 - Personal Interest	0	0.00%
4 - Thesis Related	0	0.00%
3 - Supervisor's Suggestion	0	0.00%
2 - Compulsory	21	100.00%
1 - Other	0	0.00%
NA / No Answer	0	0.00%

Q11. For question 11, if answer is other please give a reason

Q12. What are the course/seminar requirements?

5 - Oral Presentation	0	0.00%
4 - Written exam	20	95.24%
3 - Essay	0	0.00%
2 - Written comments on seminar reading or other writing duties	0	0.00%
1 - Participation in discussion or no specific requirements	0	0.00%
N/A - Fulfilled Requirements in Other Seminars	1	4.76%

Q13. Was the course mandatory for you and did you take the course for credits?

5 - Mandatory course for departmental teaching credits	19	90.48%
4 - Mandatory course no credits	0	0.00%
3 - Optional / elective course taken for departmental credits	1	4.76%
2 - Optional / elective course taken fully without credits	0	0.00%
1 - Auditing for several sessions only	0	0.00%
NA / No Answer	1	4.76%

Q14. To what extent does this course/seminar overlap "in terms of content" with others?

5 - Very much	5	23.81%
4 - Considerably	3	14.29%
3 - Average	3	14.29%
2 - Not Very much	4	19.05%
1 - Not at all	4	19.05%
NA / No Answer	2	9.52%

Which course(s)/seminar(s) overlap with others?

Response 1: Micro, Macro, Metrics....

Response 2: All of the economics courses

Response 3: Microeconomics I, Macroeconomics I

Response 4: Mathematics topics are used in all the courses in the Micro-Macro series

Response 5: Mostly all need the mathematical tools learned in this course

Response 6: All of them

Response 7: All of them

Response 8: Microeconomics

Response 9: Micro, macro and econometrics

Response 10: Micro economics

Response 11: Micro, macro

Q15. To what extent did the central themes of this course/seminar match your expectations?

5 - Very much	12	57.14%
4 - Considerably	6	28.57%
3 - Average	2	9.52%
2 - Not Very much	0	0.00%
1 - Not at all	0	0.00%
NA / No Answer	1	4.76%

Q16. Practical classes have been very useful for the learning and understanding of the subject?

5 - Very much	15	71.43%
4 - Considerably	5	23.81%
3 - Average	0	0.00%
2 - Not Very much	0	0.00%
1 - Not at all	0	0.00%
NA / No Answer	1	4.76%

Q17. If this course was co-taught, Do you agree that co-teaching improved the course?

5 - Very much	2	9.52%
4 - Considerably	1	4.76%
3 - Average	0	0.00%
2 - Not Very much	3	14.29%
1 - Not at all	3	14.29%
NA / No Answer	12	57.14%

Q18. Please provide your open comments and feedback in relation to individual professor co-teaching the course.

Response 1: Professor Villanacci is an excellent lecturer, his explanations are great to follow and even though a lot of material needs to be covered, he makes the major points of every topic very clear and understandable.

Response 2: In this case, I cannot think of any other professor doing what Professor Villanacci does. He is clear, kind and able to make math even "fun" in some sense. The program is complete and well explained.

Response 3: I thought that the material was perhaps a little too detailed in certain areas but certain topics that would merit further elaboration such as the envelope theorem or the implicit function theorem. In general though this is a very good module.

Q19. Do you think the teaching assistant (Doctoral Researcher or Post-Doctoral Fellow) was well organised and prepared?

5 - Very much	19	90.48%
4 - Considerably	1	4.76%
3 - Average	0	0.00%
2 - Not Very much	0	0.00%
1 - Not at all	0	0.00%
NA / No Answer	1	4.76%

Q20. Do you think the teaching assistant (Doctoral Researcher or Post-Doctoral Fellow) was available and approachable outside seminar hours?

5 - Very much	19	90.48%
4 - Considerably	1	4.76%
3 - Average	0	0.00%
2 - Not Very much	0	0.00%
1 - Not at all	0	0.00%
NA / No Answer	1	4.76%

Q21. In your opinion, what topics were omitted that should have been included?

Response 1: I would have liked to have more emphasis on fixed point theorems but considering time constraints I am really satisfied

Response 2: Hamiltonians, Optimal Control

Response 3: Envelope theorem, implicit function theorem

Q22. What topics should have been reduced/omitted?

Response 1: Vector Spaces

Response 2: You can go a bit faster over the KT section - the notes are very clear and exhaustive.

Response 3: The notation was somewhat heavy at times

Response 4: Topology

Q23. What topics covered in the course/seminar did you find particularly valuable?

Response 1: Implicit Function Theorem

Response 2: Topology, IFT, Non-linear programming

Response 3: Topology, Implicit function theorem, Non-linear programming

Response 4: Most of the material was really helpful for the Micro 1 course

Response 5: Non-linear programming, Implicit Function Theorem

Response 6: functions, topology, maximization

Response 7: Topology

Response 8: Topology and Kuhn-Tucker part

Response 9: Implicit Function Theorem, Dynamic Programming

Response 10: all of them

Response 11: Kuhn Tucker

Response 12: Linear Algebra, Dynamic Programming

Q24. How could the teaching format and learning results for this course be improved?

Response 1: The dispersion over time. Either it should be an intensive course with classes TA and exam before the rest (except probability) or it should drag in time. This mixture is complicated.

Response 2: If possible, start the background course in Mathematics earlier in the academic year.

Response 3: If possible, increase the number of hours to have more time to cover all the material (for instance, by starting one week earlier in August)

Response 4: Have more hours to speed the lecture down a bit

Response 5: I do not think there is anything that should be changed. Maybe a fewer topics with less speed...

Response 6: Better coordination with other modules.

Response 7: Too many topics were crammed into the course, I feel.

Q25. Do you have any further comments about the course/seminar?

Response 1: The class was really nice, the professor and TA were very enthusiast. This was a great experience.

Response 2: The course was really interesting and I would be eager to follow other courses by Prof. Villanacci on other mathematical topics

Response 3: Thank you for a very good course!

Response 4: Villanacci is an amazing teacher

Response 5: Wonderful preliminary class

Response 6: No.

Response 7: The professor and the TA did an amazing job at explaining the concepts insightfully.

Q26. Was the sequence and structure of the course clear?

5 - Very much	18	85.71%
4 - Considerably	3	14.29%
3 - Average	0	0.00%
2 - Not Very much	0	0.00%
1 - Not at all	0	0.00%
NA / No Answer	0	0.00%

27. Was the course well connected with previous courses/preparatory courses?

5 - Very much	12	57.14%
4 - Considerably	2	9.52%
3 - Average	2	9.52%
2 - Not Very much	0	0.00%
1 - Not at all	0	0.00%
NA / No Answer	5	23.81%

28. Course Content additional comments:

29. Were slide/lecture notes provided to you?

Yes	19	90.48%
No	1	4.76%
NA / No Answer	1	4.76%

30. Were the slide/lecture notes clear?

5 - Very much	16	76.19%
4 - Considerably	3	14.29%
3 - Average	0	0.00%
2 - Not Very much	0	0.00%
1 - Not at all	0	0.00%
NA / No Answer	2	9.52%

31. Were the slides/lecture notes sufficient to understand the topics covered in class?

5 - Very much	15	71.43%
4 - Considerably	4	19.05%
3 - Average	0	0.00%
2 - Not Very much	0	0.00%
1 - Not at all	0	0.00%
NA / No Answer	2	9.52%

32. Were the slides/lecture notes well connected with the actual lecture?

5 - Very much	18	85.71%
4 - Considerably	1	4.76%
3 - Average	0	0.00%
2 - Not Very much	0	0.00%
1 - Not at all	0	0.00%
NA / No Answer	2	9.52%

33. Did the Professor provide references to other sources for deepening your understanding (e.g. textbooks, related articles, supplemental material)?

Yes	18	85.71%
No	2	9.52%
NA / No Answer	1	4.76%

34. Were the slides/lecture notes well connected to these complementary sources?

5 - Very much	9	42.86%
4 - Considerably	5	23.81%
3 - Average	2	9.52%
2 - Not Very much	0	0.00%
1 - Not at all	0	0.00%
NA / No Answer	5	23.81%

35. Written Notes and References additional comments:

Response 1: Best class notes ever <3

Response 2: The material for this course is excellent

36. Did the problem sets help you deepen your understanding of the basic concepts covered in class?

5 - Very much	15	71.43%
4 - Considerably	5	23.81%
3 - Average	0	0.00%
2 - Not Very much	0	0.00%
1 - Not at all	0	0.00%
NA / No Answer	1	4.76%

37. Did the problem sets provide insights that went beyond the basics covered in class?

5 - Very much	6	28.57%
4 - Considerably	7	33.33%
3 - Average	6	28.57%
2 - Not Very much	1	4.76%
1 - Not at all	0	0.00%
NA / No Answer	1	4.76%

38. Was the material/references provided by the lecturer sufficient to solve the problem sets?

5 - Very much	17	80.95%
4 - Considerably	2	9.52%
3 - Average	1	4.76%
2 - Not Very much	0	0.00%
1 - Not at all	0	0.00%
NA / No Answer	1	4.76%

39. The level of difficulty of the problem sets were:

5 - Too easy	0	0.00%
4 - Easy	0	0.00%
3 - Neither easy nor hard	12	57.14%
2 - Hard	8	38.10%
1 - Too hard	0	0.00%
NA / No Answer	1	4.76%

40. Problem Sets additional comments:

Response 1: The structure of the problem set is fair. In order to solve them, you need to understand and study what is written in the notes. Not all the answers are there, but you can easily manage to find them by yourself.

Response 2: I really enjoyed this class

41. Was there sufficient time to discuss the problem set in the T.A class?

5 - Very much	8	38.10%
4 - Considerably	7	33.33%
3 - Average	3	14.29%
2 - Not Very much	2	9.52%
1 - Not at all	0	0.00%
NA / No Answer	1	4.76%

42. Did the T.A. explain harder/trickier parts of the problem set well?

5 - Very much	15	71.43%
4 - Considerably	4	19.05%
3 - Average	1	4.76%
2 - Not Very much	0	0.00%
1 - Not at all	0	0.00%
NA / No Answer	1	4.76%

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43. Did the T.A. respond to the problems and difficulties raised by the class?

5 - Very much	18	85.71%
4 - Considerably	2	9.52%
3 - Average	0	0.00%
2 - Not Very much	0	0.00%
1 - Not at all	0	0.00%
NA / No Answer	1	4.76%

44. Did you feel that the T.A. sessions were more useful than simply reading written solutions?

5 - Very much	15	71.43%
4 - Considerably	4	19.05%
3 - Average	0	0.00%
2 - Not Very much	1	4.76%
1 - Not at all	0	0.00%
NA / No Answer	1	4.76%

45. Did you feel that the T.A. understood the material sufficiently better than the students?

5 - Very much	13	61.90%
4 - Considerably	7	33.33%
3 - Average	0	0.00%
2 - Not Very much	0	0.00%
1 - Not at all	0	0.00%
NA / No Answer	1	4.76%

46. T.A. Sessions additional comments:

Response 1: Elia's TA were well structured and clear. I particularly appreciated the initial overview on the topics he gave us at the beginning of each TA session.

Response 2: The TA did a good job, but at this level TA sessions that just go over the algebra are not particularly useful. I would prefer that there be more discussion of the concepts in the TA classes, but I think this is a minority view.

Response 3: The TA was very organised, structured and well prepared. He was able to explaining the concepts very insightfully, and he clearly had deeper knowledge of the concepts. He improved my learning considerably.

47. On average, how many hours per week did you spend on this course?

0 hours	0	0.00%
1 - 3 hours	0	0.00%
4 - 7 hours	8	38.10%
8 - 10 hours	9	42.86%
11 hours +	3	14.29%
NA / No Answer	1	4.76%

48. What percentage was this of the total average time you spent on courses per week?

Between 0% and 20%	8	38.10%
Between 20% and 40%	10	47.62%
Between 40% and 60%	0	0.00%
Between 60% and 80%	2	9.52%
Between 80% and 100%	0	0.00%
NA / No Answer	1	4.76%

49. What percentage of this time spent on this course was spent on problem sets?

Between 0% and 20%	0	0.00%
Between 20% and 40%	2	9.52%
Between 40% and 60%	7	33.33%
Between 60% and 80%	7	33.33%
Between 80% and 100%	4	19.05%
NA / No Answer	1	4.76%

50. What percentage of the time spent on this course was spent on general background studying and reading?

Between 0% and 20%	6	28.57%
Between 20% and 40%	10	47.62%
Between 40% and 60%	3	14.29%
Between 60% and 80%	1	4.76%
Between 80% and 100%	0	0.00%
NA / No Answer	1	4.76%

51. What percentage of the time spent on this course was spent on other things?

I spend between 0% and 20% other things	18	85.71%
I spend between 20% and 40% other things	2	9.52%
I spend between 40% and 60% other things	0	0.00%
I spend between 60% and 80% other things	0	0.00%
I spend between 80% and 100% other things	0	0.00%
NA / No Answer	1	4.76%

52. Based on your response from the previous question what do you spend this percentage of time doing?

Response 1: Doing past exams

Response 2: Discussing some topics outside the problem sets with classmates

Response 3 Nothing

53. How much of the course material was familiar to you before the course?

5. Most	4	19.05%
4. A lot	3	14.29%
3. A moderate amount	5	23.81%
2. A little	6	28.57%
1. None at all	2	9.52%
NA / No Answer	1	4.76%

54. Of the material that was familiar did you manage to deepen your understanding?

5 - Very much	9	42.86%
4 - Considerably	9	42.86%
3 - Average	2	9.52%
2 - Not Very much	0	0.00%
1 - Not at all	0	0.00%
NA / No Answer	1	4.76%

55. Additional comments:

Response 1: I really enjoyed this course.

Response 2: It could be an idea to have this course run and examined before microeconomics and econometrics start, since it's a background course anyway.

56. Any other remarks:

Response 1: I only wish there had been time to cover the topics more profoundly. Given the time, I think the professor and the TA did the best possible job.
